

I found a \$70B ecommerce gold rush hiding in plain sight

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Jul 17, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HuoWRlvD1xo> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Australian activewear brand LSKD is quietly dominating a booming running apparel niche worth \$100B+. This video dissects their product, landing page, and meta ads strategy, then shows beginners exactly how to replicate it lean using Alibaba, Zendrop, and Shopify.

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The Brand: LSKD Overview [0:00](#)

- LSKD is an Australian direct-to-consumer activewear brand
 - Primary markets are Australia and New Zealand
 - Receives **1.9 million monthly visitors**
- Their bestselling product is the *Accelerate 3-in High-Rise Running Short* in Ultra Pink / Candy Pink
 - Described as "ultra lightweight and flexible" with a "barely there feel"
 - Available in multiple colors, but the pink colorway is the clear hero SKU
- The brand is used throughout the video as a case study for a replicable ecommerce playbook

The Running Market Opportunity [1:11](#)

- The global running market is estimated to grow to **over \$100 billion by 2026**
 - CAGR estimated at 5–7.5%, though Arie believes real growth is likely faster
 - He calls the official estimates conservative based on anecdotal social signals
- Two macro trends are converging to drive this niche:

- **High-rise bottoms** — a long-running, sustained fashion trend among women across pants, jeans, and now athletic wear
- **Running culture resurgence** — a rapidly growing lifestyle movement, especially visible on social media
- Cultural signals supporting the running boom:
 - Running clubs are proliferating across the US and globally
 - The app **Strava** (run tracking + social competition) is surging in popularity
 - Arie notes this appears to be a global trend, evidenced by an Australian brand seeing massive traction
- Practical observation tip: go outside in summer and count how many women are wearing this style of running short — Arie says there are "a lot"

Product & Landing Page Breakdown 1:57

- LSKD's product page is intentionally minimal — "things sort of sell themselves" in this niche
 - Strong lifestyle imagery is the primary driver; it highlights color and fit at a glance
 - The product description is short: "Designed for maximum mobility and comfort"
 - Key copy phrase: **"barely there feel"** — Arie flags this as a likely core ad hook
 - Aspirational framing: "Whether you're pushing your limits or enjoying a light jog, these shorts keep you at your fastest"
- The page leans heavily on **social proof** (strong reviews) and cross-sells via related products
- Key product positioning insight:
 - Color alone can be a differentiator in a crowded feed — the pink colorway stands out without any other gimmick
 - The brand speaks directly to "the runner avatar" rather than a general athleisure buyer

Ads Strategy & Meta Ads Library 3:14

- LSKD runs **880 active Meta ads simultaneously**
 - This sounds extreme but is normal for brands spending heavily on paid social
 - Logic: more creative volume = more ammo for Meta's algorithm to find the best-performing ads
- Arie's context: he runs meta ads at his agency **Ami** and spends **six figures per month** on his own brand
- The Meta Ads Library is **free and publicly accessible** — Meta is legally required to show all active ads
- Top-performing ads (sorted by highest impressions) are simple:
 - Ad 1: "Restocked — our #1 selling run short in the most dreamy two-tone colorway. Free shipping on all orders. Shop before it's gone again."
 - Uses real (or implied) scarcity + authority ("#1 selling") in one line
 - Visual: just the pink shorts — the color does the heavy lifting
 - Ad 2: Promotes a **2-for-\$150 bundle deal**

- Arie notes he personally doesn't see the value, but emphasizes: don't judge offers by your own perspective — think like your target customer
- Key advertising lesson: **understand your avatar's life**, not just their demographics
 - If you're not your target customer, you must study who they are and what motivates them
- Instagram presence: consistent posting, good engagement — not viral, but strong for their scale
 - Benchmark comparison: **Rhod** (another ecom brand Arie admires) gets hundreds of thousands of likes per post — LSKD doesn't reach that level but still builds solid community

How to Source & Fulfill a Similar Product 7:21

- Arie's sourcing approach for a beginner replicating this model:
 - Step 1 — Search **Alibaba** for "women's running shorts"
 - Filter for products with strong colors and the high-rise, barely-there silhouette
 - Prioritize visual feed appeal and quality
 - Step 2 — Identify a shortlist; Arie specifically flagged one pink high-rise option as something he'd personally test
 - Step 3 — Send an inquiry to the Alibaba supplier
 - Step 4 — Order a **small batch (e.g., 10 units)** with your logo to minimize risk
 - Step 5 — Connect your Alibaba supplier with **Zendrop** (referred to as "Team Drop" in transcript)
 - Zendrop has warehouses in China and ships products **globally**
 - You communicate with them via WhatsApp
 - They hold your inventory and fulfill orders worldwide on your behalf
 - Step 6 — Ship your branded stock from the Alibaba supplier directly to Zendrop's warehouse
- Why this setup works:
 - You don't need a large upfront inventory commitment
 - Global fulfillment is handled without building your own logistics
 - Both Alibaba and Zendrop have free tiers — no upfront platform cost
- Arie's own brand context: he uses this exact Alibaba + Zendrop model and does **over \$100,000/month in recurring revenue**

Launching Your Store: Tools & Stack 9:58

- **Shopify** — recommended as the non-negotiable storefront platform
 - LSKD itself runs on Shopify
 - Current deal: **\$1/month for the first 3 months**
 - Low risk: if a store doesn't work, start a new one or iterate on the same one
- **Meta Ads Library** — free competitive research tool; view any brand's active ads at any time
- **Get Hooked** — the paid tool Arie used to discover LSKD

- Only paid tool in the stack; not required
- Free alternative: manually scroll Instagram and use the Meta Ads Library
- **Zendrop ("Team Drop")** — free fulfillment/warehousing platform; connect to Alibaba supplier via WhatsApp
- **Alibaba** — free supplier marketplace for sourcing custom/branded product

The entire stack (minus Get Hooked) is free. The core playbook: find a trending product on Alibaba, brand it, store it with Zendrop, sell it on Shopify, and advertise via Meta — modeled after what's already working at scale.

- Arie's closing philosophy: model what successful brands do, apply your own creative touch, and give yourself the highest probability of success without reinventing the wheel